

7.9a

Describing trends 1

Worksheet

A Match these adverbs with their definitions:

Speed

- 1 quickly a a slow, step-by-step change
2 gradually b a constant, regular change
3 steadily c a rapid change

Amount

- 4 significantly d a small change
5 sharply e a large change
6 slightly f a sudden change

Now study phrases a–f and answer questions 7–12.

- a Sales grew slowly.
b We saw a steady improvement in our brand image.
c We had a considerable decrease in our market share.
d Our profits rose sharply.
e There was a slight growth in inflation.
f Unemployment fell significantly.

Which of the phrases a–f:

- 7 describe a movement up? 10 describe a medium or large movement?
8 describe a movement down? 11 have a 'verb + adverb' structure?
9 describe a small movement? 12 have an 'adjective + noun' structure?

B Complete the table with words from the box. Some words are used twice.

improve improvement fall (x2) although rise (x2) increase (x2)
stay the same As regards decrease (x2) due to remain constant

	▲	▶	▼
Verbs	go up	be stable	go down
Nouns	growth	no change	collapse

	cause	contrast	moving to a new topic
Linking words	because (+ subject + verb) because of (+ noun phrase)	but	In relation to

- Write the past simple of these verbs:

go up _____ grow _____ rise _____ fall _____

C Rewrite these 'verb + adverb' phrases as 'adjective + noun' phrases.

- 1 Sales grew slowly. ▶ There was a slow growth in sales.
2 Profits rose sharply. ▶ We had a _____
3 Unemployment fell significantly. ▶ We saw a _____
4 House prices were stable. ▶ There was _____